

Product Brief v3.3

Partner-or-exit edition, roadmap lock-in. Draft for founder review.

0. What changed from v3.2

- **Three future-value features locked into the roadmap**, each scoped to the guardrails from their review: a compensation-claim assist (EU261-style, client-reviewed only), a corporate duty-of-care view (per-traveler Diffs, never a forced push), and an event-surge signal for the budget ring (via an event-intelligence API, with hyper-local micro-inflation explicitly dropped for lack of a reliable data source).
- **New explicit boundary:** no auto-filed compensation claims, no power-of-attorney claim handling, no airport-retail voucher issuance — added to both Non-goals and Won't (now), since this sits right next to the payments line we already draw.
- Everything else — the hero theme, the logo, the Trip Shaper, the Essentials layer, the Signal-Plan-Diff engine, and the schema — is unchanged from v3.2.

1. Thesis

An agency's relationship with a traveler tends to go quiet after the ticket is sold, right when the traveler meets delays, weather, budget drift, and unfamiliar streets. Séjour spans the whole arc instead: it shapes the destination and budget before a ticket exists, then watches the journey and re-plans around the traveler's fixed points, guards the budget, and explains every safety call, so the agency stays useful from first idea to flight home. *Agencies own the booking. Séjour owns the journey — before, during, and after.*

2. Who it's for

Buyer or partner: travel agencies and travel companies selling air travel at home and abroad (leisure agencies, corporate travel management companies, online agencies). Start with one segment and one or two route corridors.

End users: the agency's travelers, everyone. Personas are presets over one engine (anchors, constraints, signals), not separate products.

Why an agency would care (hypotheses to validate in the first conversations):

- Higher conversion: a traveler reaches checkout with a costed, sold-on plan instead of an abandoned browser tab.
- Fewer disruption calls: travelers get options proactively instead of phoning the agency.
- More ancillary revenue: contextual offers (transfers, lodging, insurance, connectivity) at the moment of need.
- Retention: the agency stays useful between one booking and the next.
- Duty of care for corporate clients: see who is exposed and show that you acted, down to their own travel manager's view of their own people.

Beyond booking and flight tracking, Séjour adds: a pre-booking Trip Shaper, anchor-aware itineraries, live re-plans with approval, a predictive budget guardrail, evidence-based solo safety, health-aware planning, opt-in

nearby essentials, offline contingencies, and compensation assistance when a flight disruption qualifies for it.

3. Strategic path: partner or exit

- **Partnership:** white-label or co-branded module, priced per active traveler or per trip, with optional revenue share on ancillaries.
- **Acquisition:** a buyer wants working technology, a pilot with real usage, clean IP, and the team. Build so both paths stay open.
- **Design principle:** easy to plug in, hard to replace. Easy: API, webhooks, tenant theming, booking-agnostic ingestion. Hard to replace: the signal-plan-diff engine, tuned safety and health constraints, and accumulating trip-time data.
- **Stay out of booking and payments.** It avoids card-data compliance scope and the agency's core lane — this now explicitly includes staying out of claim-filing and voucher issuance too (see Section 4).

4. Goals and non-goals (v1)

Goals

1. A live white-label pilot with one or two agency design partners.
2. A traveler gets a costed Trip Shaper estimate before booking, which the agency can use as a qualified lead.
3. Ingest a booked itinerary from the agency and produce a monitored plan.
4. A traveler approves a proposed re-plan in one tap, and an agent can approve on their behalf.
5. A traveler can find their opted-in essentials (hospital, pharmacy, embassy, their place of worship) near where they're staying.
6. Agency outcomes (disruption contacts, ancillary attach, conversion, engagement) agreed before the pilot starts.
7. Every safety call shows its evidence.

Non-goals

- Booking, ticketing, or payments.
- A consumer app-store launch.
- A single "safety score."
- Auto-applying changes without approval.
- Serving every persona at once.
- Specialized advice outside travel logistics: visa or immigration, medical diagnosis or treatment, or religious guidance beyond listing locations.
- Auto-filed compensation claims, power-of-attorney claim handling, or airport-retail voucher issuance — compensation assistance stays a reviewed packet the traveler submits themselves.

5. Core model

- **Tenant:** an agency, with its own brand tokens, users, and data boundary.
- **Trip:** an itinerary that moves through stages — shaping (pre-booking estimate), booked (ingested from the agency), in progress, completed.
- **Anchor:** a fixed point (co-working, meeting, gym, clinic) with a travel-time reach, time-of-day aware.
- **Essential:** an opt-in category (hospital or urgent care, pharmacy, embassy or consulate, place of worship, ATM or currency) that surfaces nearby matching places automatically, without a manually configured anchor.
- **Constraint:** budget cap and buffer, sensitivities, mobility, safety preferences.
- **Signal:** a typed event (weather, flight, transit, advisory, event demand) with severity, confidence, expiry.
- **Plan:** Plan A per day plus a pre-baked Plan B.

- **Diff:** a proposed change caused by a signal (proposed, approved, undone) — always scoped to one traveler, even when a corporate manager's action affects many at once.
- **Ledger:** transactions. Burn rate is derived, never stored.

6. Signature experiences

- **Trip Shaper:** before a ticket exists, a costed estimate — flights, stay, activities, a starting budget cap — so the traveler reaches checkout already sold, and the agency gets a warmer lead.
- **The Pivot:** snow at 6am, the day re-flows around the anchor, one tap to approve.
- **Guardrail Ring:** "At this pace you hit your cap on day 9. Three swaps get you back."
- **Event-Aware Budget:** a concert or summit landing nearby pushes local prices up before the traveler notices it — the ring adjusts its forecast ahead of the surge instead of reacting after.
- **Safe Walk:** night-mode isochrone and a lit route home.
- **Nearby Essentials:** opt-in categories light up near your stay — hospital or urgent care, pharmacy, embassy or consulate, your place of worship, currency exchange — sorted before you need them.
- **Why this?:** evidence, confidence, and freshness behind every safety call.
- **Offline Plan B:** itinerary and contingencies work with no signal.
- **Compensation Assist:** when a flight delay clears a jurisdiction's compensation threshold (EU261 to start), Séjour pre-fills the claim packet from the flight data it already has — the traveler reviews and submits it themselves.
- **Agent console:** a control tower listing travelers at risk and proposed diffs; agents approve or take over.
- **Duty-of-Care View:** a scoped window for a corporate client's own travel manager onto just their own people — who's exposed right now, and a single action that proposes the same kind of re-route to everyone affected, each still approved traveler by traveler.
- **Contextual offers:** when a Diff needs a hotel or transfer, agency-approved offers appear inline and deep-link to the agency's own checkout.

7. Requirements (MoSCoW)

Must

- Multi-tenant accounts with white-label brand tokens.
- Trip Shaper: destination, dates, and party size in; a costed estimate with a confidence range out, feeding the budget cap.
- Flight itinerary ingestion (agency feed, or confirmation parsing as fallback).
- Flight-status and weather signals; Pivot with diff approval and undo.
- Anchors with isochrone reach; Plan B; predictive budget ring.
- Essentials layer (universal categories): hospital or urgent care, pharmacy, embassy or consulate, ATM or currency — deterministic POI lookup near the stay and anchors, no LLM required.
- Evidence panel for one safety layer.
- Agent console (view and approve).
- REST API, webhooks, and an embeddable widget.
- Tenant data isolation, consent, export and deletion.
- Analytics for the agency KPIs in section 12.

Should

- Essentials layer (identity-linked category): place of worship by tradition, with its own consent flow and agent-console visibility control.
- Accommodation shortlist when none is booked yet, matching budget, anchors, and safety evidence.
- Transit-delay signal, night Safe Walk, offline mode.

- Notifications through push, SMS, or the agency's preferred channel.
- SSO for corporate tenants.
- Contextual offers with deep links.

Could

- Community reports, calendar sync, group trips, extra brand presets.
- Extra essentials categories (connectivity or eSIM, laundry, pet services, and similar).
- Visa or document-expiry reminders (informational only, not legal advice).
- Compensation-eligibility detection and a pre-filled claim packet for one jurisdiction (EU261 to start) — traveler reviews and submits it themselves; no auto-filing, no power of attorney, no vouchers.
- Corporate duty-of-care portal: a scoped view for a corporate client's own travel manager within their agency tenant; bulk actions broadcast a Signal that generates individual per-traveler Diffs, never a forced push.
- Event-surge signal (via an event-intelligence API such as PredictHQ) feeding the budget ring; hyper-local micro-inflation tracking stays out for lack of a reliable data source at that granularity.

Won't (now)

- Booking, payments, native apps, emergency-dispatch features.
- Specialized advice outside travel logistics: visa or immigration, medical diagnosis, or religious guidance beyond listing locations.
- Auto-filed compensation claims, power-of-attorney claim handling, or airport-retail voucher issuance.

8. Architecture

- **Frontend:** React, TypeScript, Tailwind on CSS-variable tokens. Traveler view as a PWA and embeddable widget (signed-token handshake); agent console as a separate app. GSAP for the Pivot and ring.
- **Backend:** FastAPI. Postgres with PostGIS (isochrones) and pgvector (review search), plus row-level security for tenant isolation. Redis for cache and queues, plus a job queue for the signal loop. n8n only for scheduled ingestion.
- **Integration surface:** REST API and webhooks (trip.ingested, signal.created, diff.proposed, diff.approved), per-tenant keys with OAuth2, SAML or OIDC SSO for corporate tenants.
- **Itinerary ingestion:** booking-agnostic. Accept the agency's feed (derived from its GDS or NDC data, or a back-office export), or parse confirmation emails. The agency keeps the booking data; Séjour never has to be a booking API.
- **Signal loop:** ingest, normalize to Signals, threshold check (per-tenant, tunable), and only if tripped an LLM proposes a re-plan as a Diff, then notify.
- **AI rules:** safety-critical logic is deterministic; the LLM proposes and explains, never decides alone; structured outputs; replay evals of real disruptions; per-tenant cost caps. Essentials lookups are deterministic POI queries, never routed through the LLM, so identity-linked categories never enter a prompt.
- **Corporate duty-of-care scoping:** travelers optionally carry an employer reference within their agency tenant; a corporate-admin role can only see and act on travelers sharing that reference, and "act" always means broadcasting a Signal — the engine still writes one Diff per affected traveler, never a shared or forced write.
- **Providers (behind an adapter layer, two candidates each):**
  - Flight status: Amadeus announced its self-service portal would shut down on July 17, 2026. Evaluate dedicated flight-status APIs (FlightAware AeroAPI, AirLabs, AviationStack) or the agency's own operational feeds.
  - Maps and places: one ecosystem. Google Places results on a map must appear on a Google Map, and caching is restricted beyond place IDs, so pair Mapbox with OSM or Overture data (check licenses) or go all Google.
  - Weather: OpenWeatherMap or Open-Meteo; check commercial terms.
  - Lighting: OSM lit tags (coverage varies, so show confidence) plus official open data.

- Event intelligence: PredictHQ or a comparable event-impact API, for the concert/summit demand-surge signal.

9. Data model (sketch)

```
{
  "tenant": { "id": "tnt_01", "brand": "preset_agency_a", "role": "processor" },
  "traveler": {
    "id": "usr_948275A",
    "employer_ref": null,
    "budget": { "cap_minor": 250000, "currency": "USD", "buffer_pct": 15 },
    "constraints": [{ "kind": "avoid", "tag": "high_pollen", "hard": true }],
    "essentials": {
      "categories": ["hospital", "pharmacy", "embassy"],
      "place_of_worship": { "opted_in": false, "tradition": null },
      "visible_to_agent": false
    },
    "anchors": [{ "id": "anc_1", "type": "co-working", "point": [43.6425, -79.3871],
      "reach": { "mode": "walk", "max_minutes": 20, "night_rules": "lit_only" } }]
  },
  "trip": { "id": "trp_01", "stage": "shaping", "source": "agency_feed",
    "estimate": { "flight_range_minor": [45000, 62000], "stay_range_minor": [80000, 120000], "confidence": 0.7 },
    "segments": [{ "flight": "XX123", "from": "LHR", "to": "YYZ",
      "departs": "2026-10-02T09:40:00+01:00" }] },
  "signals": [{ "id": "sig_1", "type": "weather.snow", "severity": 0.6,
    "confidence": 0.8, "observed_at": "2026-10-03T05:40:00-04:00",
    "expires_at": "2026-10-03T18:00:00-04:00", "affects": ["day_3"] }],
  "plan": { "day_3": { "a": ["item_1", "item_2"], "b": ["item_5"], "active": "a" } },
  "diffs": [{ "id": "dif_1", "trigger": "sig_1", "status": "proposed",
    "changes": [{ "op": "swap", "from": "item_2", "to": "item_5" }] }]
}
```

- Money is integer minor units plus currency. Burn-rate status is computed, never stored.
- Sensitive traveler data stays server-side and encrypted; only compiled constraints reach any LLM prompt.
- `essentials.place_of_worship` is off by default and stored separately from the general profile; `visible_to_agent` defaults to false so agent-console staff never see identity-linked opt-ins unless the traveler turns that on.
- `employer_ref` is optional and only set for corporate-tenant travelers; it's what scopes the Duty-of-Care View to one company's own people.

10. Trust, privacy, compliance

- **Roles:** the agency is the data controller and Séjour is the processor. Provide a data processing agreement, tenant isolation, and audit logs.
- **Essentials consent:** universal categories (hospital, pharmacy, embassy, ATM) are on by default as a convenience layer. Identity-linked categories (place of worship, and any future category tied to a protected attribute) are off by default, require explicit opt-in, are excluded from any LLM prompt, and stay hidden from the agent console unless the traveler separately turns on agent visibility. Treat these as special-category data under GDPR Article 9 and equivalents, deletable independently of the rest of the profile.
- **Compensation-packet copy:** the claim packet is informational, not legal advice, and its wording needs a legal review per jurisdiction before it ships in that market — see Section 15.
- **Safety panel, not a score:** components (lighting, transit hours, reports), confidence, freshness, and careful wording to avoid stigmatizing neighborhoods.
- **Autonomy ladder:** suggest, one-tap approve, then auto for low-stakes changes with undo. Safety-critical changes never auto-apply — and neither does a corporate manager's bulk action, which always resolves to individual traveler-approved Diffs.
- **Data:** minimize, encrypt sensitive fields, explicit consent, export and delete, keep sensitive data out of third-party prompts and logs. Plan for GDPR plus the law of your home jurisdiction.
- **Diligence-ready:** record the license terms of every provider, keep a security baseline (encryption, access control, logging), and plan a later security certification.
- **Positioning:** a planning aid, not a security service. Add disclaimers and local emergency numbers.

11. Design system

- **Tokens in three layers:** brand, semantic status (ok, watch, alert), surface. Themes are token swaps on CSS variables.
- **Hero theme: Solar Horizon** (Golden Hour Sunrise #FF6B35 and Deep Oceanic Teal #004E64, set in Plus Jakarta Sans and Satoshi). Mediterranean Escape and Tropical Cyber ship as the two alternate presets; an agency can still supply its own logo, colors, and fonts on top.
- **Contrast guard:** body text must reach 4.5:1 or better. Deep Oceanic Teal #004E64 is about 9.2:1 on white, so it's safe for text and headers. Golden Hour Sunrise #FF6B35 is about 2.8:1, so it stays to fills, icons, and large bold accents, never body text. (The alternate themes carry the same split: Amalfi Blue #0077B6 at 4.9:1 is text-safe; Limoncello #FFD166 at 1.4:1 is not.)
- **Status vs. brand orange:** the hero accent is a warm orange, close to a typical "watch" or "warning" hue. Give status colors their own distinct hues, clearly apart from Golden Hour Sunrise, and always pair status with an icon and a label — so the budget ring's amber warning is never mistaken for the brand mark.
- **Motion:** the Pivot animation shows what moves and what stays; honor reduced-motion settings. Replace neomorphic cutouts with outlined or glass cards that meet contrast.
- **Mobile-first:** thumb-zone actions, explicit offline state, skeleton loading.

12. Business model and metrics (hypotheses)

- **Model:** B2B licensing to agencies, per active traveler or per trip, plus a platform fee and optional ancillary revenue share. Set prices after design-partner conversations.
- **Cost drivers:** LLM, map, flight-status, and event-intelligence calls. Track cost per active traveler-day and keep gross margin visible for diligence.
- **Agency KPIs (agree before the pilot):** pre-booking to booking conversion rate, disruption contacts per 100 trips, ancillary attach rate, in-trip engagement rate, traveler satisfaction, time to resolve a disruption.
- **Product KPIs:** share of proposed Pivots accepted, time from signal to approved diff, D7 and D30 retention among invited travelers.
- Set numeric targets after measuring the agency's baseline.

13. Roadmap

- **Phase 0 (2 to 4 weeks):** 8 to 10 agency conversations (pains, current tools, integration appetite), choose a design partner, clickable Pivot and agent-console prototype on mock data.
- **Phase 1, single-tenant pilot:** Trip Shaper estimate, universal Essentials categories (hospital, pharmacy, ATM, embassy), itinerary ingestion, flight-status and weather signals, Pivot with approval, budget ring. Postgres, PostGIS, FastAPI, Redis.
- **Phase 2, platform:** multi-tenancy, white-label tokens, API and webhooks, agent console, identity-linked Essentials category (place of worship) with its consent flow, night Safe Walk, offline, notifications, and Could-haves as capacity allows (event-surge signal, compensation assist, duty-of-care view).
- **Phase 3, proof and packaging:** pilot readout, pricing, diligence pack, second partner, community reports.
- **Checkpoint after Phase 1:** if agency KPIs do not move, fix the core loop before adding features.

14. Acquisition-readiness checklist

- **IP:** signed assignments from every contributor, an open-source license audit, no borrowed client code.
- **Data licenses:** recorded terms per provider, with no display or caching violations.
- **Security and privacy:** encryption, access control, logging, DPA template.
- **Contracts:** pilot agreement with clear data roles and IP ownership.
- **Traction:** pilot report showing agency KPIs.

- **Economics:** cost per active traveler-day and gross margin.
- **Technical docs:** architecture diagram, runbooks, reproducible deploys.
- **Entity:** clean company structure and cap table (confirm with a lawyer).

15. Risks and open questions

Risks

- Agencies may build in-house or already use disruption and duty-of-care tools.
- Long agency sales cycles.
- Provider dependency (the Amadeus lesson).
- Safety liability and false confidence.
- LLM cost and latency.
- Identity-linked essentials (place of worship) touch protected-attribute data; rushing the consent and visibility design could cause real harm or compliance exposure.
- Compensation-claim features touch consumer-protection law per jurisdiction; even scoped to a review-only packet, the copy and disclaimers need legal sign-off before launch in any given market.

Open questions

- Which agency segment and route corridors first? *(founder)*
- Is there an agency contact who could be the design partner? *(founder)*
- What do target agencies use today for disruptions and duty of care? *(research)*
- Which essentials categories are on by default at launch, and which stay opt-in only? *(founder, legal)*
- Which jurisdiction's compensation rules to support first — EU261 is the obvious start, given how clearly it's defined — and does legal need to review the claim-packet copy before the pilot? *(founder, legal)*
- Which map ecosystem? *(engineering)*
- Which entity and jurisdiction govern data compliance? *(legal)*